Yasmeen Latip Junaid

Atty. Yasmeen Latip Junaid, CPA — known affectionately online and in classrooms as **Teacher Yang** — is a Filipino corporate lawyer, certified public accountant, academic, and digital advocate from the island province of Basilan in the southern Philippines. She stands at the rare crossroads of rigorous legal-financial expertise and compassionate grassroots mentorship, and within the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), she's recognized as a trailblazer for Moro women navigating corporate governance and professional education.

Contents

1 BACKGROUND AND EARLY LIFE
2 EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL FORMATION
3 ACADEMIC CAREER
4 "TEACHER YANG": THE DIGITAL VOICE
5 SIGNIFICANCE IN BANGSAMORO CONTEXT
6 SEE ALSO
7 REFERENCES

BACKGROUND AND EARLY LIFE

Yasmeen Latip Junaid grew up in Basilan, an island province in the southwestern Philippines with a storied cultural identity and a complex socio-political past. She comes from two of the region's proudest indigenous Muslim communities: her father, Muktar Junaid, is Tausug — the dominant ethnolinguistic group of the Sulu Archipelago with a centuries-long tradition of maritime trade, scholarship, and governance. Her mother, Hon. Brenda Latip Junaid, belongs to the Sama Banguingui, a seafaring indigenous people whose communities are woven across the coastal landscapes of Basilan and Sulu. The Junaid surname itself carries historical weight, tracing back to the Al-Junaid Arab clan ancestry — a lineage with deep roots in the Islamization of the Sulu region. Coming of age in a province long defined by both conflict and resilience, Yasmeen absorbed early on what it means to carry a community's story forward.

Leadership wasn't something she had to go looking for — it was already in the house. Her mother, Hon. Brenda Latip Junaid, served as the long-running Mayor of Tabuan-Lasa, a coastal municipality spanning several island communities off the Basilan mainland. Together with her husband, Muktar Junaid, the elder Junaid steered local peacebuilding and reconciliation programs through some of the region's most difficult years. Growing up in that environment, Yasmeen

Atty. Yasmeen Latip Junaid, CPA



Photo: Atty. Yasmeen Latip Junaid, CPA

Also Known As

Teacher Yang

Origin

Basilan, BARMM, Philippines

Ethnicity

Tausug (paternal) and Sama Banguingui (maternal); ethnolinguistic communities of Southwestern Mindanao and the Sulu Archipelago

Education

Bachelor of Science in Accountancy
Juris Doctor, Silliman University College of Law

Credentials

absorbed a deep sense of civic responsibility and community-rooted leadership long before she set foot in a courtroom or lecture hall.

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL FORMATION

Junaid chose a demanding dual track — one that required mastery of both the precision of numbers and the philosophy of law.

She earned her degree in Accountancy and, in October 2012, cleared the notoriously difficult Philippine CPA Licensure Examination. That credential in hand, she pushed further: she enrolled at the **Silliman University College of Law** in Dumaguete City, where she quickly made her mark as a skilled oralist. Her team represented Silliman at the **International Humanitarian Law (IHL) Moot Court Competition**, advancing to the semifinals and taking home the **Best Respondent Memorial** award — a distinction that signals not just legal knowledge, but the ability to defend it under pressure.

After earning her Juris Doctor, she cleared the Philippine Bar Examination, completing the rare double distinction of being both a licensed CPA and an Attorney-at-Law. It's a combination that's uncommon anywhere in the country, and genuinely exceptional for someone from the Bangsamoro region.

Certified Public Accountant (CPA Licensure, October 2012)
Attorney-at-Law (Philippine Bar)

Profession

Lawyer; Certified Public Accountant; Academic; Digital Advocate

Academic Affiliation

Universidad de Zamboanga (UZ), Zamboanga City

Professional Memberships

Philippine Institute of Certified Public Accountants (PICPA)
Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP)

Family Background

Daughter of Hon. Brenda Latip Junaid (Sama Banguingui), former Mayor of Tabuan-Lasa, Basilan; and Muktar Junaid (Tausug)

Notability

One of BARMM's few dually licensed CPA-Lawyers; Tausug-Sama Banguingui woman of Al-Junaid lineage pioneering corporate-legal practice and professional education

Known For

Mentoring bar and board examinees under the persona "Teacher Yang"; mental health advocacy for professional students; Faculty Moderator, JPIA-Universidad de Zamboanga

ACADEMIC CAREER

Junaid returned to Western Mindanao to bring that expertise home, joining the faculty of the **Universidad de Zamboanga (UZ)** in Zamboanga City, where she teaches advanced courses across the law and accounting departments.

Her presence in the classroom has been anything but ordinary. Knowing how steep the hurdles are for regional students trying to pass national board exams, she stepped up as the long-serving **Faculty Moderator of the Junior Philippine Institute of Accountants (JPIA)** at UZ. Under her guidance, the local chapter developed structured peer-review networks and intensive academic bootcamps aimed at lifting passing rates for aspiring CPAs in the region.

Beyond the classroom, Junaid works as an active research panelist and academic referee for UZ's business programs. She has served as a thesis evaluator for undergraduate and postgraduate research, including studies on financial literacy and financial planning habits among business students, and has contributed to proposing institutional strategies for building small-enterprise resilience in the local economy.

Her professional civic ties extend across the PICPA and the Integrated Bar of the Philippines. She also maintains a direct connection to her home province through her seat on the Executive Council of the **Sigma Chi Beta Chapter** at Basilan State College.

"TEACHER YANG": THE DIGITAL VOICE

For many followers across Mindanao and beyond, Atty. Junaid is simply **Teacher Yang** — the warm, candid, deeply relatable voice behind a Facebook page with over 13,000 followers.

She built that platform deliberately, as a counter-narrative to the cold, clinical image that usually surrounds law and accounting professionals. Through video reels and personal blog posts written in a distinctly Filipino **hugot** style — emotionally resonant, sometimes funny, always human — she talks openly about the mental health struggles that come with professional board preparation: the burnout, the imposter syndrome, the fear of failure. It's a space that's rare in Philippine professional culture, and clearly needed.

Her recurring message to examinees is uncomplicated: move at your own pace and trust the process. By putting her own vulnerabilities alongside her professional titles, she's created something that functions less like a fan page and more like a sanctuary — a place where the next generation of Mindanaoan scholars can feel seen.

Her advocacy has three consistent threads: mental health awareness among students and young professionals, authentic storytelling that strips away the intimidation of professional exams, and active de-escalation of exam anxiety through relatable, honest content.

SIGNIFICANCE IN BANGSAMORO CONTEXT

In a region where access to professional education has historically been uneven, and where women from indigenous communities face compounded barriers, Junaid's trajectory is more than a personal success story. She is a living proof-of-concept for what BARMM's next generation can achieve — with the right mix of determination, family grounding, and educational opportunity.

Her dual license, her academic footprint at UZ, and her digital reach together position her as one of the region's most distinct professional voices: rooted in Tausug and Sama Banguingui heritage, credentialed at the highest levels of Philippine professional licensing, and committed to bringing the knowledge back to the communities that need it.

SEE ALSO

- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)
- Tausug people
- Sama Banguingui people
- University of Zamboanga
- Junior Philippine Institute of Accountants (JPIA)
- Philippine Institute of Certified Public Accountants (PICPA)
- Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP)

REFERENCES

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